

2026-W19 MH@MERICS Weekly Update

I. HIGHLIGHTS

Spotlight: US-China Summit

- **Op-ed for [FAZ](#), “Kalkül, kein Kurswechsel”**, where I argue that the upcoming Trump-Xi summit will deliver staged optics and possibly a tariff/Boeing/agriculture “landing zone” but no strategic reset. Both sides are buying time. Underneath, three trends are accelerating: managed trade plus tech bifurcation, the entanglement of Taiwan/Iran/Ukraine, and Beijing hardening its system for prolonged confrontation – leaving Europe’s implementation gap, not its analytical toolkit, as the real problem.
- **[NZZ](#) interview “Zwei schwächelnde Giganten”** where I argue that Beijing goes into the summit with the stronger hand: resilience built up, US distracted by the Iran war, and Xi willing to grant only cosmetic gestures (Iran, Russia, LNG/soybeans) without changing course. I see a decade of two equally strong yet simultaneously weakening giants, with 2040 power defined by control over energy (China), compute (US ahead) and finance (US dominant) – and Europe’s room to manoeuvre dependent on whether it builds its own model rather than chasing the triad.
- **[MERICS Future China Conversation](#) recording**: I sat down with **Prof. Wang Jisi (PKU), a leading scholar of international and US-China relations** to discuss **the current trajectory of US-China relations** ahead of the Trump-Xi summit, as well as the global implications thereof. Don’t share the link to the video. PW: “future-china”.
- In our latest **[China in 26 podcast](#)**, Claudia Wessling, Katja Drinhausen, and I discussed China’s new supply chain regulations and **also our outlook on the Trump-Xi Meeting**.
- **[Register for our online briefing](#) tomorrow: The Trump-Xi Summit, with my colleagues Jacob Gunter and Helena Legarda**. Tuesday, May 12, 9:00-9:30 CEST.

German China policy in context

GER

- **CN calls on GER to stem “EU drift toward protectionism”** ([Bloomberg](#)) during video conference with Minister Reiche, who will visit China end of the month (26-29 May to Beijing and Guangzhou, while the EU Commission debates China policy)
- New report by German Chamber of Commerce (DIHK) finds that **handling of CN end-use declarations and the challenges associated with export license applications for exports to CN constitute the primary advisory topics**, while **delivery times for critical raw materials/rare earths** from CN is gaining importance. ([DIHK Außenwirtschaftsreport 2026](#))
- **ENBW (largest provider of fast EV charging in GER) cooperates with CN supplier Xcharge in critical infrastructure** ([Business Insider](#))

Europe/EU

- **“China-EU investment deal should stay in deep freezer”** (outgoing “trade chief” (S. Weyand, [SCMP](#)))
- **BEL urges EU (again) to save industry by getting tough on China** ([Politico](#))

- **SWE arrests CN captain of suspected Russia-linked vessel** ([Reuters](#))
- **IRL data protection authorities investigate Shein over data transfer to CN** ([heise](#))
- **Lobbying report by China Chamber of Commerce to the EU (CCCEU) and KPMG uses scare numbers** (430bn USD) to project cost of barring CN suppliers due to new EU Cybersecurity Act ([SCMP](#))
- **Renewed Chinese efforts to shape information environment in Brussels:** 1) [Brussels Teahouse Substack newsletter](#), 2) Upgraded presence of ICES ([Institute for China-Europe Studies](#))

[Link](#)

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- **Social democratic think tank / publisher doubles down on China overcapacity problem** ([Social Europe](#); related [INTA study](#))
- **Europe Day and EU delegation reception + EU-China Think Tank Dialogue and 2nd conference on EU-China relations in China** (featuring our colleague Bernhard Bartsch): Amb. Toledo hosted 1,000+ guests incl. VFM Hua Chunying and from 27 EU member states, conference tomorrow ([EEAS 1](#), [EEAS 2](#))
- **Euractiv “The Ring” debate features S&D** (cautioning against escalation) **and EPP** (warning about power shift) **MEPs to discuss EU trade policy** ([Euractiv](#))

G7 and global context:

- **G7 trade ministers meet in Paris (ahead of G7 leaders’ Summit in June).**
Communiqué focus was on critical minerals. There is broad agreement on the need to reduce reliance on CN, but significant differences about how to do so; meeting overshadowed by renewed US threats to raise EU auto tariffs from 15% to 25% ([US News](#))
- **US revises UN resolution on Iran but CN, RU, still expected to veto** ([Reuters](#))
- **EU, Brazil and CN launch coalition to boost integrity and effectiveness of carbon markets** ([Climate Action](#))

II. SELECTED RESEARCH AND INSIGHTS

MERICS research and (media) insights | CN debates/views corner | International sources: 1. Domestic economic situation/policy | 2. Politics and society | 3. Geoeconomics: trade, tech, finance, investment, industrial policy and competition | 4. Foreign policy / “Global China” | 5. Strategic implications and responses

MERICS research and (media) insights

Publications

- Last week, our MERICS China Essentials covered the resumption of fuel exports by China, China’s blocking of US oil sanctions, and Emission quotas for local cadres ([LINK](#), [PDF](#)).
 - **Jacob Gunter: “Beijing is still restricting fuel exports to Asia, but by allowing the resumption of some shipments, it is helping to keep afloat regional economies with which China is closely interdependent and gaining more influence in the region. Desperate Asian governments will**

now take all the fuel they can secure from China, but this crisis will increase the pressure on them to strengthen national economic and energy resilience via diversification and/or the onshoring of refining capacity.”

- **Helena Legarda: “Beijing is once again showing the world that even potential geopolitical or economic costs will not deter it from putting its national interests and grand strategic ambitions first.** China’s teapot refiners ensure a steady flow of cut-price oil, and Beijing is willing to risk confrontation with the US to maintain this – and to show it will stand firm against any assertion of Washington’s long-arm jurisdiction.”
- **Johanna Krebs: “The integration of binding emission quotas into the local cadre evaluation system is meant to show that China is serious about reaching peak emissions by 2030 by incentivizing local officials to implement national climate policy.** But the actual degree of ambition remains unclear. Only when the relevant ministries publish detailed targets will it become apparent whether this is a symbolic policy or a genuine, hands-on transformation of the system.”
- **Wendy Chang: “China’s early moves in dealing with technology-driven employment challenges show that it is aware of the changes AI will bring,** and likely to demand more from its businesses in shouldering the responsibility. With its aggressive investment in AI solutions and a massive labor force already facing unemployment issues, it will have little choice but to be an early example in tackling AI-driven job loss.”
- Last week’s Soapbox [Issue 246](#) (Soapbox Trade × MERICS): Taiwan’s export map tilts toward the U.S.; Bratislava feels the chill of China’s car slowdown; China bought what it still could from the Dutch chip-tool giant; China still dominates EU smartphone imports; EU agri-food exports to China could return to 2017 (pre-African swine fever) levels in 2026; China is earning more from IP, but the U.S. remains far ahead.

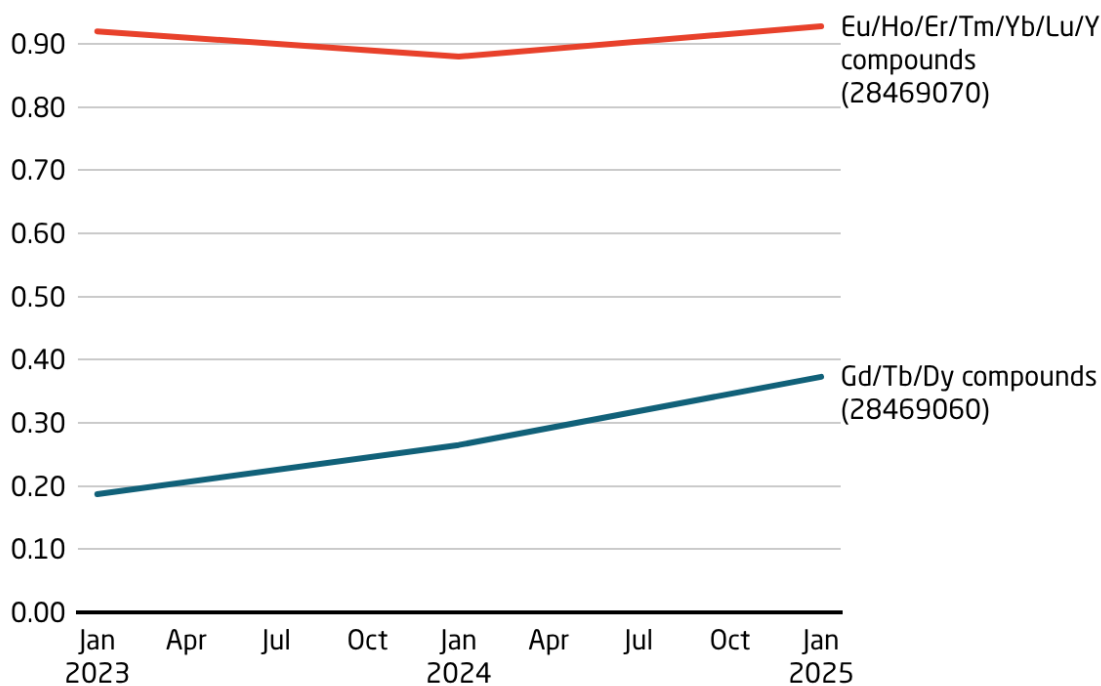
Media

- [The Strait Times](#) cited our recent [report](#) on embodied AI in their piece on ‘robo-cops’.
- The BBC’s [Asia Specific](#) podcast had Wendy Chang to talk about the undone Manus deal and the intensifying US-China AI rivalry.
- [The Strait Times](#) asked Claus Soong on China’s strategy with regards to Taiwan in the run-up to the Trump-Xi summit.
- [SCMP](#) quoted Helena Legarda on increasing export control and regulations complicating EU-China ties.

EU rare-earth dependence on China



Share of EU imports from China by HS code, 2023-2025 (%)



Source: Eurostat

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EU solar inverter imports overwhelmingly from China



Share of EU solar inverter imports from China, 2025 (%)



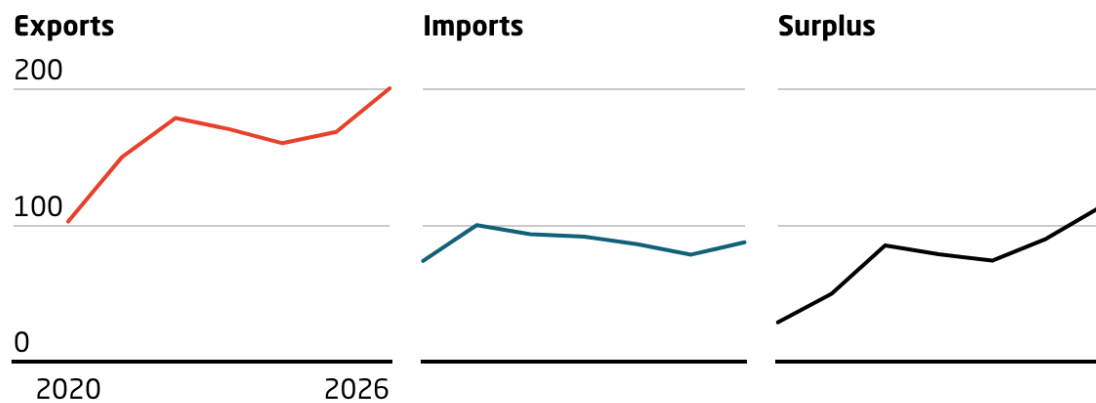
Source: Eurostat

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China-EU trade Jan-Apr: 2026 surplus hits new high



China trade with the EU, January-April, US\$ billion, 2020-2026



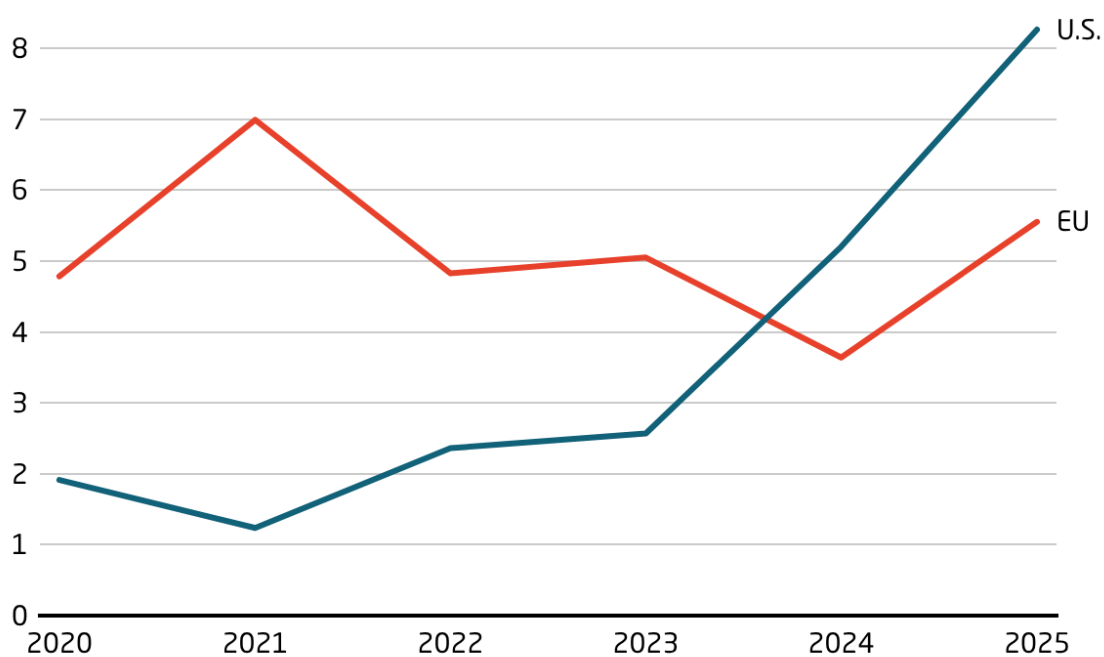
Source: GACC

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China's aircraft imports: U.S. overtakes EU in 2024



China imports of aeroplanes (HS 880240) from EU and U.S., US\$ billion, 2020-2025



Source: GACC

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China per capita disposable income is rising (but skewed: high outliers skew average)



Yuan per resident, 2024-2025 (median ~16% below average)

■ Average ■ Median



Source: NBS

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Chinese debates and views corner

(Sources are selected based on relative prominence/virality on the Aisixiang platform, time filter: past two weeks)

Zhang Ying: “张颖：构建周边命运共同体的理论内涵、实践探索及前景 (Theoretical Connotation, Practical Exploration, and Prospects of Building a Community of Common Destiny with Neighboring Countries)”, 2026-05-09, [Link](#)

Vice Dean and Professor at the School of International Relations, Beijing Foreign Studies University — focuses on China’s neighbourhood diplomacy and regional community-building concepts.

- **A doctrinal write-up of Xi’s post-2025 periphery framework:** pulls together the 2025 Central Conference on Work Relating to Neighboring Countries — the “five homes” vision, the amity-security-prosperity-sincerity-inclusiveness-shared-destiny principles, BRI as primary platform, and an “Asian security model” of shared security and dialogue.
- **An operational checklist for a China-led Asian order:** head-of-state diplomacy as the lead instrument, resilient regional supply chains, new security cooperation models, and people-to-people exchanges — each presented as a building block toward an Asia organised on Chinese terms.

Zhou Fangyin: “周方银：特朗普 2.0 美国对外战略调整及其对中国周边环境的影响 (Trump 2.0: US Foreign Strategy Adjustments and Their Impact on China’s Periphery)”, 2026-05-09, [Link](#)

Professor at the School of International Studies, Sun Yat-sen University, and distinguished researcher at the Guangdong Provincial Research Center for Xi Jinping Thought on

Socialism with Chinese Characteristics for a New Era — specialist on great-power relations and China's peripheral diplomacy.

- **Trump 2.0 is, on balance, a net win for China's periphery:** Zhou argues US focus has shifted to the homeland and Western Hemisphere, investment in China's neighbourhood has fallen, and confrontation with Asia-Pacific allies has eased — all upgrades to China's strategic environment.
- **Coercion and ally reshaping are wrecking US standing in Asia:** economic coercion, military pressure and diplomatic blackmail, combined with how Trump is treating allies, have collapsed US image and leadership in the region — opening space for deeper Chinese economic integration with affected neighbours.

Lin Yifu: “林毅夫：中国人均 GDP 达到美国一半时，美国就会接受中国崛起 (The US Will Accept China's Rise When China's Per-Capita GDP Reaches Half of the US Level)”, 2026-05-02, [Link](#)

Former World Bank Chief Economist (2008–12) and Honorary Dean of Peking University's National School of Development; leading proponent of “New Structural Economics” and one of the most prominent CCP-aligned development economists (Taiwan-born).

- **For Lin, US acceptance is a matter of time, not negotiation:** at the Wuzhen 15FYP salon, Lin argues that once Chinese per-capita GDP reaches roughly half the US level, US strategic accommodation follows automatically — turning the rivalry into demographic arithmetic.
- **The West is heading into a “Lost 20 Years”:** he cites the 28 Feb 2026 US-Israel strike on Iran, the Russia-Ukraine war and Gaza as evidence of accelerating Western decline, and positions the 15FYP as the plan that keeps China compounding through it.

1. Domestic economic situation/policy

Caixin: “Why China Needs a World-Class Service Sector”, 2026-05-05, [Link](#)

- **State Council unveils 20 measures to push services past 100 trillion yuan by 2030:** The policy targets institutional barriers, pushing producer services toward high-end specialization and consumer services toward eldercare and childcare.
- **Services already drove 61.4% of growth in 2025:** The sector employs roughly half the workforce, according to figures cited in the article.

Trivium: “Beijing wants SOEs to invest in private tech companies”, 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **A revised SOE assets law would steer state capital into private tech:** The April 30 draft - updating a 2009 law - requires SOEs to take minority equity stakes in private technology companies, according to the article.
- **109 articles, 32 of them new:** The draft was released for public comment by the legislature and is currently under review.

Trivium: “MIIT pushes digital transformation with standards plan”, 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **MIIT's May 6 draft pushes light industry toward standardised digital transformation:** The plan targets hundreds of new product and process standards, according to Trivium Tech.

- **Factory-floor standardization is the plan's primary focus:** MIIT's draft targets data interfaces and communication protocols, though the full text remains paywalled.

Economist: "DeepSeek and Alibaba rescue China's office landlords", 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **A Hangzhou court has barred firms from replacing staff with AI:** The late-April ruling protects employment in China's AI capital, where Alibaba alone employs 128,000 people.
- **AI hiring is selectively reviving Chinese office markets:** Tech firms' headcount growth is generating office demand in a few cities with major AI hubs, The Economist reports.

SCMP: "China's 'common prosperity' push faces reality check as inequality rises: study", 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **Wealth Gini has nearly doubled since 1995:** Zhejiang University economist Li Shi reports China's wealth inequality measure rose from 0.45 to above 0.7 between 1995 and 2023.
- **Real household income growth has halved post-2018:** Li's data show average annual real income growth fell from around 8 per cent to below 5 per cent, with low- and middle-income groups most affected.

Caixin: "China's Rural Migrant Workers Age as Shift to Services Weighs on Pay", 2026-05-05, [Link](#)

- **Average migrant worker hit a record 43.3 years old in 2025:** Workers over 50 reached 32% of the total, the highest share since NBS records began in 2008.
- **Services now absorb 54.7% of migrants as construction's share collapses to 13.8%:** The structural shift toward lower-paying jobs slowed monthly income growth to 2.3%, reaching 5,075 yuan (\$710).

Nikkei: "China corporate earnings down for 3rd straight year", 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **A third straight year of falling profits for listed Chinese firms:** Total net profit across 5,400 non-financial companies fell 2% to 2.54 trillion yuan, the first three-year decline in data going back to 2000.
- **One in four listed companies booked a net loss, led by property and retail:** 1,458 firms were in the red - nearly 100 more than the prior record year - with 59 of 108 real estate firms loss-making and retailers as a sector turning negative.
- **Exporters carried the earnings story while domestic demand stayed flat:** Steel exports to Southeast Asia and semiconductor profits rose, while government subsidy effects faded in H2 2025 and youth unemployment ticked back up to 16.9% in March.

SCMP: "China's EV battery giants thrive while carmakers' profits shrink amid price wars", 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **Auto assemblers earned just 3.2% margins in Q1 vs 6% downstream:** The gap reflects flat vehicle prices and declining new car sales, according to the China Passenger Car Association.
- **Battery and chip suppliers set to keep outpacing assemblers:** Buoyant energy-storage demand is boosting suppliers like CATL while carmakers continue passing profit pressure downstream, analysts said.

2. Politics and society

Foreign Affairs: “Xi’s Forever Purge”, 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **The “self-revolution” is being built as permanent governance design:** The authors argue Xi is building institutional party discipline as a succession substitute, intended to make the CCP durable beyond any individual leader.
- **Discipline filings hit one million in 2025, a sevenfold rise:** Three Politburo members fell in one term for the first time since the Mao era, the article reports.
- **Overcentralized discipline now risks tipping into bureaucratic paralysis:** Tighter penalties incentivize local officials to conceal problems and comply mechanically rather than solve them.

Foreign Policy: “Who Is Xi’s Real No. 2?”, 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **Cai Qi may not actually be Xi’s true deputy:** Li Qiang outranks Cai on key commissions and presides at the Central Economic Work Conference, reflecting greater substantive institutional authority.
- **By design, Xi has eliminated any genuine second-in-command:** The author argues power is deliberately divided among trusted associates so no subordinate can form an independent center beneath Xi.

NYT: “China Sentences 2 Former Def. Ministers on Bribery Charges”, 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **Suspended death sentences for two former defense ministers cap the PLA purge’s most senior verdicts to date:** Gen. Wei Fenghe and Gen. Li Shangfu were convicted on bribery charges by military courts, Xinhua announced on 7 May.
- **The military purge has shrunk the CMC from seven to two members:** Around 100 senior officers have been dismissed or placed under investigation since the campaign began, per a recent CSIS estimate cited in the article.

Related: [SCMP](#), [Trivium](#)

NYT: “How A.I. Is Transforming China’s Entertainment Industry”, 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **AI microdramas flooded Douyin with 50,000 uploads in March alone:** The month alone nearly matched Douyin’s entire 2025 volume, with the AI segment projected at over \$3 billion this year according to Chinese state media.
- **Regulators have mandated consent before any digital likeness is used:** The rules, introduced last month, followed actor job losses and incidents of real people’s faces appearing without permission in AI-generated microdramas on ByteDance platforms.

SCMP: “Mainland CN students turn to HK universities amid gaokao, US visa worries”, 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **Hong Kong has overtaken the US as mainland students’ second study destination:** The Blue Book cites gaokao competition, US visa uncertainty from Sino-US tensions, and residency planning as the main drivers.
- **Non-local postgraduate enrolment in Hong Kong jumped 207% in three years:** Hong Kong doubled non-local student quotas to 40% of local places from 2024-25, deepening the trend.

Caixin: “Mega-Donations Push China’s University Fundraising to Historic High”, 2026-05-06, [Link](#)

- **A record year for China’s university foundations in 2024:** Large gifts totalled 12.17 billion yuan - 2.3 times 2023’s level and a record since Mingshandaos began tracking in 2015.
- **One Yu Renrong share transfer made Ningbo Eastern Institute the top recipient:** The Will Semiconductor founder donated 4.18 billion yuan in shares, giving Ningbo Eastern a 4.33 billion yuan total.

Trivium: “Central government introduces ‘Beautiful China’ KPI framework for local officials”, 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **“Beautiful China” provincial KPIs land via joint Central Committee-State Council directive:** The joint directive establishes a framework to evaluate local official performance against Xi Jinping’s flagship environmental initiative.
- **The new KPI system layers on top of an existing climate accountability mechanism:** Beijing is layering enforcement tools, linking official career incentives to environmental targets at the provincial level.

WSJ: “I’m Leaving China After 8 Years. Suspicion of Outsiders Is Rising.”, 2026-05-06, [Link](#)

- **The anti-espionage campaign has produced raids on foreign firms and an executive jailed:** American due-diligence offices were searched and at least one Japanese businessman sentenced for espionage, the author reports from eight years as a Beijing correspondent.
- **Chinese disapproval of the US ran at 81% in Tsinghua’s 2024 poll:** Japan scored worst and Russia highest in Chinese public favorability surveys; anti-foreigner attacks in 2024 included the fatal Shenzhen stabbing of a Japanese schoolboy.

3. Geoeconomics: trade, tech, finance, investment, industrial policy and competition

Wire China: “Trump’s Board of Trade Move Signals the U.S. has Given Up on Changing China”, 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **The Beijing summit will debut a managed-trade framework:** The “Board of Trade” would designate products eligible for bilateral trade regardless of tensions, leaving advanced chips off-limits, according to sources close to the talks.
- **Washington effectively accepts China’s state model and drops liberalization demands:** The plan ends Washington’s decades-long effort to induce structural reform in China’s economy, signaling acceptance of its state-dominated system, the article reports.
- **Talks are targeting roughly \$30-40 billion of designated imports each way:** A “tariff canyon” mechanism would lower duties on approved goods and raise them on blocked categories, sources tracking the negotiations say.

Atlantic Council: “As the Trump-Xi summit draws closer, trade uncertainty still looms large”, 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **The Supreme Court IEEPA ruling forced a tariff rebuild via Section 301 and 232:** China’s effective tariff rate fell from ~145% to ~23.7% after February’s ruling, according to the article.
- **Export controls, soybean quotas and the Busan truce review top the Trump-Xi agenda:** The US may ease semiconductor controls in exchange for rare earth licensing relief, while China’s 25 million metric ton annual soybean pledge is reportedly on track.

AP: “China says April exports jump 14.1% from a year ago ahead of Trump-Xi summit”, 2026-05-09, [Link](#)

- **April exports rose 14.1% year-on-year, beating expectations:** Exports to the US rebounded to +11.3%, recovering from a 26.5% drop in March, while imports grew 25.3%.
- **Trade and export controls dominate the Trump-Xi summit agenda next week:** Analysts cited by AP expect only incremental steps on tariffs and tech restrictions, not major breakthroughs.
- **The Iran war is now feeding into Chinese exporters’ costs:** Higher oil and fuel prices are feeding through to factory costs, according to BNP Paribas, while global inflation could dampen purchasing power in China’s overseas markets.

Andrew B Kennedy: “Rebellious Follower: China’s Search for Science, Technology, and Innovation”, 2026-04-28, [Link](#)

- **Reframes Xi’s tech push as ideology-driven, not threat-driven:** Kennedy’s seven-decade history shows the current “guided innovation” paradigm — government-guided funds, “enlisting and leading,” national strategic S&T strength, NWNS — was consolidated *before* the 2018 trade war, with GGFs scaled in 2015–16 and the NSFC reorientation pre-dating US chip controls; external pressure intensifies but did not create China’s statism, undercutting Western analyses that read every move as defensive.
- **Codifies the “rebellious follower” pattern as the structural limit on convergence:** Across imperial-era exposure, Mao’s mass-science detour, Deng’s “anchoring/releasing” balance, and today’s NWNS, Chinese elites have repeatedly imported Western paradigms but localized them under socialist economic ideology — Deng himself never abandoned the state’s capacity to “concentrate forces” — meaning calls (e.g. World Bank 2012) for China to adopt laissez-faire innovation systematically misread the paradigm in which CCP leaders actually operate.
- **Exposes guided innovation as a high-cost gamble with documented internal flaws:** Kennedy assembles Chinese-authored evidence that GGF capital chases poor targets, subsidies disproportionately favor loss-making/older/less-productive firms, university-industry collaboration scored *worse* in 2019 than 2012, innovation consortia are often “old wine in new bottles,” and EV tax exemptions alone hit ~\$40bn in 2023 — suggesting Europe should hedge against both a partial-success scenario (autonomy-over-efficiency suffices for Beijing) and a Chinese policy correction toward laissez-faire if internal critics gain ground post-Xi.

Nikkei: "Nvidia's Jensen Huang says China should not have its most advanced chips", 2026-05-05, [Link](#)

- **Huang backs US chip leadership while opposing China access to top-tier hardware:** Nvidia's CEO stated China should not have the "latest and greatest chips" but urged Washington to preserve US firms' ability to sell older models in China.
- **H200 sales to China hinge on both US approval and Beijing's own quantity rules:** Nvidia received US export clearance for the H200 earlier this year; Nikkei Asia reports Beijing is separately weighing limits on how much Nvidia may sell in the Chinese market.

FT: "DeepSeek nears \$45bn valuation as China's 'Big Fund' leads investment talks", , [Link](#)

- **The Big Fund is in talks to lead DeepSeek's first investment round:** China's state semiconductor vehicle - not previously invested in LLMs - is targeting a \$45bn valuation alongside Tencent, the FT reports.
- **DeepSeek's latest model is optimised for Huawei's Ascend chips:** Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang warned that if AI models globally "run best on non-American hardware," it would be "a horrible outcome" for the United States.

Bloomberg: "China Calls On Germany to Stem EU Drift Toward Protectionism - Bloomberg", , [Link](#)

- **Beijing leans on Berlin to resist EU protectionist drift:** Commerce Minister Wang Wentao urged German Economic Minister Reiche to help maintain open China-EU trade relations in a Friday video call, the ministry said.
- **Reiche heads to China in late May:** The German minister plans trips to Beijing and possibly Guangzhou, according to people familiar with the matter.

Caixin: "Chinese Firms Press Ahead in Europe Despite Rising Barriers", 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **Chinese firms keep expanding in Europe despite mounting trade defense measures:** Industry leaders at the Caixin London Atlantic Dialogue said companies are pressing ahead with European expansion notwithstanding the Foreign Subsidies Regulation and International Procurement Instrument.
- **BYD's Hungary EV plant has entered trial production, full ramp-up due Q2-Q3:** The plant anchors a localization strategy pairing EV manufacturing with integrated solar and battery storage offerings, the article reports.

Foreign Policy: "China Tests a Rare Tool in Its Sanctions Arsenal", 2026-05-06, [Link](#)

- **Earlier blocking-statute restraint is attributed to corporate lobbying:** The author suspects Chinese firms quietly pressured Beijing to avoid activation, fearing compliance losses rather than strategic preference for caution.
- **Palmer ties the timing to Iran war-diminished US credibility:** China may see the conflict as lowering the cost of open defiance, with its 2025 critical minerals leverage success reinforcing that perception, the article argues.

WSJ: "China Steps Up U.S. Sanctions Fight, Defying Blacklisting Over Iranian Oil", 2026-05-05, [Link](#)

- **For the first time, China invoked its 2021 blocking rule:** Beijing's Commerce Ministry ordered Chinese companies not to comply with US sanctions on Chinese refineries buying Iranian oil, citing foreign laws that violate international norms.
- **A Hengli Petrochemical unit was sanctioned in April for Iranian crude purchases:** Washington also warned financial institutions of secondary sanctions exposure for facilitating transactions with sanctioned Chinese refiners.
- **Beijing frames the move as pre-summit signalling:** Analysts cited by the article describe the blocking order as pressure to force a negotiation reset before the Trump-Xi meeting in Beijing.

WSJ: "China Is Still Supplying Drone Factories in Iran, Russia Despite U.S. Sanctions - WSJ", , [Link](#)

- **A Xiamen firm pitched Shahed drone engines directly to Iran Watch:** Victory Technology offered Limbach L550 engines - the component powering Iran's Shahed-136 - in a wartime email blast, WSJ reports.
- **Chinese fiber-optic exports to Russia have tracked drone-war demand:** Customs data shows surges after cable-guided drone operations in Kursk and a Ukrainian strike hit Russia's domestic fiber-optic supplier in April 2025.
- **US strategy is to raise costs, not halt the dual-use flows:** Officials told WSJ that forcing Iran and Russia onto lower-quality Chinese parts is the realistic goal, citing malfunctioning Russian-made Shaheds as evidence of effect.

FT: "Inside China's massive \$3tn overseas acquisition spree", 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **Chinese firms hold \$3.3tn in offshore corporate assets, concentrated in knowledge-intensive sectors:** An NBER paper finds nearly two-fifths of Chinese outbound investment routed through tax havens, making official FDI statistics a substantial undercount of China's global corporate footprint.
- **After acquisitions, target firms' patents flatline while parent filings triple:** Acquired firms saw R&D expenditure rise but no statistically significant patent gains, while Chinese parents recorded an immediate patent surge - tripling on average, quadrupling for SOEs - following their first developed-economy acquisition.
- **The innovation spillback pattern appears unique to Chinese outbound investment:** No equivalent effect appeared for other nations' overseas acquisitions; the authors frame this as a state-driven strategy accepting short-run performance costs to internalize global technological capacity.

FT: "Chinese overseas M&A hits 5-year high despite regulatory barriers", 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **Chinese overseas M&A hit \$9.6bn in Q1, a five-year high:** Transactions rose for the fifth consecutive quarter across resources, consumer, and manufacturing sectors, per Rhodium Group data.
- **HSBC links the surge to record trade surplus and weak domestic demand:** Firms are channelling capital overseas and building foreign production to counter rising trade barriers, the bank's analysts wrote.

- **UK and Belgian authorities pushed back on Chinese acquisitions in Q1:** The UK rejected JAC Capital's FTDI chip divestment appeal; Belgium's military intelligence is investigating GDAT's acquisition of helicopter maker NHV.

4. Foreign policy / "Global China"

Europa: "EU, Brazil and China launch open coalition to boost integrity and effectiveness of carbon markets", , [Link](#)

- **China and EU co-chair a new global compliance carbon markets coalition:** The Open Coalition on Compliance Carbon Markets launched in Florence with Brazil as chair; Germany and New Zealand joined as founding members.
- **The coalition's inaugural work plan conference is set for Wuhan, September 2026:** The body covers approximately 80 carbon pricing schemes across 50 countries, with its work focused on monitoring, reporting, and verification standards.

Brookings: "Foreign investment is not making friends for China—or the US", 2026-05-06, [Link](#)

- **FDI erodes local goodwill for both China and the US:** A 750-project study across 23 African countries finds proximity to investment decreases community affinity for the investing power, despite raising perceived influence.
- **Unmet jobs and corruption perceptions drive the backlash equally:** Overpromised employment and heightened perceptions of official corruption near foreign projects erode affinity for both Chinese and American investors, the study finds.
- **China's BRI investment in Africa nearly tripled in 2025:** The article reports \$61 billion in flows - nearly triple the prior year - deployed across 53 African BRI-participating states for infrastructure and critical minerals.

Bloomberg: "China Urges France to Help Keep EU Markets Open Through Dialogue", 2026-05-09, [Link](#)

- **Beijing is now asking France to back EU trade openness:** Ling Ji urged Bertrand Dumont on Friday to encourage the EU to resolve economic disputes through dialogue, the Commerce Ministry said.
- **Ling singled out EU subsidy probes and two pending regulatory acts:** He said the Industrial Accelerator Act and Cybersecurity Act revisions risk creating trade barriers and disrupting global supply chains.

NYT: "Voters Exposed the Limits of China's Cozy Ties to Orban", 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **The CATL plant helped end Fidesz dominance in Debrecen:** Local opposition to the \$8.5 billion factory drove voters toward Tisza, flipping what had been a bastion of rock-solid support for Orban.
- **Hungary has been Beijing's primary economic beachhead inside the EU:** Orban's "all-weather partnership" with Xi made Hungary the largest single destination for Chinese investment in Europe, with CATL and BYD among the anchor projects.
- **CATL rushed to engage the incoming government within days of the vote:** The company faces review of state aid estimated at \$350-900 million promised under a classified 2022 deal with the Orban government.

WSJ: "Taiwan Outfoxes China in Test of Wills Over Tiny African Country", 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **Beijing pressured three African states to deny Taiwan's president overflight rights:** Seychelles, Madagascar, and Mauritius refused transit permits for Lai's chartered flight to Eswatini, which Taipei attributed to Chinese economic coercion.
- **\$180 billion in African loans underpins China's diplomatic leverage:** Zambia, owing \$6.6 billion to Chinese lenders, cancelled a scheduled human-rights conference after Beijing objected to Taiwanese participants' attendance.
- **Lai still reached Eswatini via an undisclosed clandestine route:** Taiwan's president announced his arrival on social media; officials declined to reveal the method until after his return to Taipei.

FT: "Solomon Islands ousts PM who sought to balance China and west", , [Link](#)

- **Solomon Islands PM Manele has been ousted by a no-confidence vote:** He had signed a 2022 security deal with China as foreign minister and a A\$190mn Australian police-expansion agreement as prime minister in 2024.
- **Australia's A\$190mn Solomon Islands police deal now hangs in the balance:** Lowy Institute research director Sora said the initiative could be "all up in the air" under a new prime minister.
- **China-aligned candidates are the probable Manele successors:** Sora named former PM Sogavare - who switched Solomon Islands' diplomatic recognition from Taiwan to Beijing in 2019 - and Peter Agovaka as likely replacements.

NYT: "Trial Begins for Man Accused of Running Secret Police Outpost for China", 2026-05-06, [Link](#)

- **A US citizen is on trial for running a Beijing-directed Manhattan police outpost:** Lu Jianwang, 64, faces charges of acting as unauthorized Chinese government agent; co-defendant Chen Jinping pleaded guilty to the same charge in December 2024.
- **The station was directed by Beijing to locate and harass diaspora dissidents:** Prosecutors say Lu threatened China-based relatives of those refusing repatriation and received instructions from Chinese officials to locate a pro-democracy activist.

FT: "British-Chinese nationals found guilty of spying for Hong Kong", 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **Two Hong Kong-linked agents convicted under the UK National Security Act:** The Old Bailey found both guilty of surveilling pro-democracy activists for Hong Kong's foreign intelligence service between December 2023 and May 2024.
- **Wai used his Home Office database access to monitor dissidents:** Prosecutors said Yuen directed him to surveil the UK Hong Kong protest movement, with exiled activist Nathan Law among those targeted.

Economist: "China thinks America is declining but still uniquely dangerous", 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **Beijing scholars credit Trump with four inadvertent strategic gifts to China:** A January report sarcastically cited his alienating of US allies, boost to China's credibility, innovation pressure, and demonstration of American "imperial twilight."

- **The verdict from Beijing: a US in decline but still uniquely dangerous:** The Economist's Chaguan reports that Beijing frames Trump as both symptom and accelerant of American decline - not its underlying cause.

FT: "Opinion: China is building soft power as Trump burns bridges", 2026-05-05, [Link](#)

- **Polls in four US allies now favour China over America:** Significant majorities in Germany, France, Britain, and Canada said it is "better to depend on China than the US," the article reports.
- **Trump-era coercion has undercut Washington's own anti-Huawei case:** Washington warned allies that Chinese tech enabled economic coercion; US tariffs and EU burner-phone advisories now apply the same logic against America, the author contends.
- **India fast-tracked Chinese tech investment after Trump alienation:** Following US tariffs and Trump's pro-Pakistan statements, the Modi government announced expedited approval for minority Chinese ownership in seven strategic sectors, the article reports.

NYT: "Opinion: Trump Is Coming to a China That Has Moved On", 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **China has moved past the era of American admiration:** Trump's tariff wars and the Iran conflict have completed America's shift from model to "troublesome distraction to be managed," the essay argues.
- **US-educated Shanghai professionals now treat America as a cautionary tale:** The author reports returnees citing homelessness, political dysfunction, and declining living standards as signs the US no longer inspires.

Economist: "The pact that could help America and China repair relations", 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **Baucus and Roach pitch a BIT as the centrepiece of the May 14-15 Beijing summit:** The authors argue a bilateral investment treaty would give both leaders a concrete deliverable to repair US-China economic relations after prolonged conflict.
- **The October 2025 South Korea meeting brought easing but no breakthrough:** The authors cite that prior meeting as context for why a structured initiative - rather than ad hoc diplomacy - is needed at the reset summit.

Brookings: "What will happen when Trump meets Xi?", 2026-05-05, [Link](#)

- **Beijing is holding back major concessions to exploit Trump's pre-midterm needs:** Chinese officials calculate concessions will be more valuable if offered closer to the 2026 midterms, according to Brookings experts.
- **With IEEPA tariffs struck down, Trump has lost his fentanyl leverage:** China matched Biden-era deliverables on precursor scheduling while US multilateral pressure tools were allowed to lapse, the author reports.

Time: "Why Trump's China Trip Is Set Up to Fail", 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **Cited experts predict no substantive outcomes from the Beijing summit:** Three analysts assessed the probability of meaningful agreements at or near zero, citing Chinese structural intransigence and accumulated U.S.-China dialogue fatigue.

- **China's Hormuz resilience leaves Xi with no incentive to concede:** Reserves and pipelines absorbed the energy shock better than U.S. allies, leaving Xi with little pressure to cooperate, the article reports.
- **AI has emerged as a fresh bilateral flashpoint days before the visit:** Washington accused Beijing of "industrial-scale" AI model theft this week; China simultaneously blocked Meta's Manus acquisition, the article reports.

SCMP: "Why a 5-year defence pact between North Korea and Russia could make China uneasy", 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **Russia plans a 2027-2031 military cooperation pact with North Korea:** Defence Minister Belousov announced the five-year plan after meeting Kim Jong-un in Pyongyang on April 26, according to Tass.
- **Analysts warn the deepening Russia-DPRK axis risks accelerating North Korean military modernisation:** SCMP reports that China may be uneasy, as closer Moscow-Pyongyang ties could reduce Beijing's leverage over Pyongyang.

Brookings: "How dangerous is the current China-Japan rift?", 2026-05-05, [Link](#)

- **Takaichi's Taiwan remarks have triggered China's broadest exchange freeze since 1972:** Beijing cancelled academic, business, and cultural exchanges and placed 20 Japanese firms and universities on its export control entity list.
- **Takahara puts the crisis's severity down to Xi's structural authority:** According to Takahara, the party-state machinery amplifies Xi's cues rather than moderating them - a pattern he compares to zero-COVID overreach.
- **APEC Shenzhen in November is the earliest rapprochement indicator:** Ren Xiao points to a potential Xi-Takaichi sideline meeting as the first signal that the relationship may be normalizing.

Nikkei: "No spring thaw for Japan-China diplomacy 6 months after Taiwan spat", 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **Japan-China diplomatic channels remain frozen six months on from Takaichi's Taiwan remarks:** No ministerial meetings have occurred and parliamentary cross-party exchanges have been limited to informal settings, according to Nikkei Asia.
- **Komeito's exit from the ruling coalition has cut off a key back-channel to Beijing:** The lay-Buddhist party had previously facilitated delegations and summits, and its absence leaves the Takaichi government without established intermediaries, analysts say.

SCMP: "China confirms it helped Pakistan's air force during last year's war with India", 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **An AVIC engineer confirms on-site technical support during the India-Pakistan war:** Zhang Heng told CCTV his team was deployed to Pakistan to ensure Chinese-supplied jets could "truly perform at their full combat potential."
- **Pakistan's J-10CE recorded the first combat kill for a Chinese-made fighter:** The engagement also marked the first time a French Rafale had been shot down in combat, according to SCMP.

New Yorker: “How the Iran War Is Shifting Power Toward China”, 2026-05-06, [Link](#)

- **The Iran war breaks China out of Russia-alignment isolation:** According to Johns Hopkins professor Yuen Yuen Ang, the conflict creates diplomatic space for Beijing to reposition itself more broadly - not just in the Middle East but globally.
- **Oil-shock urgency is translating into record Chinese clean-energy exports:** Solar systems, batteries, and EVs posted record March sales as Asian economies sought to insulate themselves from future Hormuz disruptions, Ember reported.
- **Gallium and Iran mediation give Xi structural leverage at the summit:** According to ICG researcher Ali Wyne, the US cannot replenish Middle East missile interceptors without Chinese gallium, nor bring Iran back to negotiations without Beijing's support.

Brookings: “Beijing’s playbook for the US-Iran war”, 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **For Beijing, Iran is a mid-tier partner; the Gulf states are the real priority:** Panelists argue Beijing has invested far more diplomatic time and economic capital in Riyadh, Abu Dhabi, and Dubai than in Tehran.
- **Brookings panelists see Beijing neither welcoming nor mourning the Iran war:** According to Hass, China preferred the stable pre-conflict environment and is unsettled by supply chain disruptions coinciding with the launch of its new Five-Year Plan.
- **US munitions depletion and Gulf carrier deployments give Beijing breathing room:** Karlin reports 25-50% of munitions critical to a China conflict have been expended, with three carrier strike groups tied to the region.

NYT: “China Seeks an Advantage With Both Trump and Iran as War Evolves”, 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **China played a back-channel role in Iran’s ceasefire acceptance:** Multiple foreign diplomats confirmed Beijing’s quiet pressure on Tehran was a decisive factor in the early April agreement, the article reports.
- **IRGC officials are openly calling for post-war alignment with China:** Voices within the Revolutionary Guard say Iran should follow Pakistan’s model and deepen security ties with Beijing, the article reports.
- **Saudi Arabia asked China to restrain Iran from attacking the kingdom:** Riyadh sees Beijing as a vested party in Saudi-Iran relations, building on the 2023 Chinese-brokered diplomatic opening, according to a Saudi official.

Caixin: “First Chinese Oil Tanker Attacked in Strait of Hormuz as Iran-U.S. Conflict Escalates - Caixin Global”, , [Link](#)

- **First Chinese tanker hit in Hormuz amid May 3-6 multi-ship attacks:** Iran’s IRGC attacked vessels from multiple nations after the US launched “Project Freedom” naval escorts through the strait, halting all commercial traffic May 5-6.
- **In Beijing on May 6, Wang Yi urged Iran to halt hostilities:** China called for negotiations, safe strait passage, and a Gulf security architecture, while also reaffirming support for Iran’s sovereignty and peaceful nuclear rights.

Foreign Affairs: “Why China Waits”, 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **Beijing is betting patience reduces the cost of unifying with Taiwan:** The authors argue near-term force is prohibitively costly and China expects its growing capabilities to compel Taiwan without a full-scale invasion.
- **Taiwan youth support for independence has fallen sharply since 2023:** Those aged 20-29 favouring independence dropped from 26.7% to 17.9%, while the share rejecting “one China” fell from 82.1% to 65.8%, per My Formosa.
- **2028 elections are the key test for Beijing’s patient strategy:** The authors argue Lai’s reelection could push China toward quarantine or closer military operations if read as momentum toward formal independence.

Straits Times: “Taiwan tops China’s agenda ahead of Trump-Xi summit”, 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **Wang Yi calls Taiwan the “biggest risk” in bilateral ties:** Beijing framed Taiwan compliance as a conditional offer to unlock broader US-China progress ahead of the May 14-15 summit.
- **Beijing has shifted from reunification rhetoric to opposing-independence messaging:** MERICS analyst Claus Soong noted a softer tone toward Taiwanese audiences, citing Beijing’s April reception of opposition leader Cheng Li-wun as a calculated signal.

Lowy Institute: “After annexation: How China plans to run Taiwan”, 2026-05-10, [Link](#)

- **Xi’s unification terms have shifted from autonomy to absorptive control:** The report finds Beijing now demands Taiwan’s full political integration into the CCP system, abandoning earlier offers of genuine self-governance.
- **PRC scholars foresee mass exclusion and imprisonment of political opponents:** Phased post-takeover governance envisions immediate security crackdowns, institutional restructuring beyond Hong Kong’s model, and decades of identity re-engineering targeting millions.
- **PRC post-unification thinking is riddled with unresolved contradictions:** Autonomy is deemed necessary but withheld as credible; coercion can deliver stability but not legitimacy; scholars offer no synthesis.

5. Strategic implications and responses

Noah Barkin: “Watching China in Europe - May 2026”, 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **The Commission will seek a European Council mandate on China in June:** Officials plan to deploy safeguards across chemicals, machinery, and PHEVs as an interim measure while developing a Section 301-style broad instrument.
- **Q1 EU-China deficit surged amid Beijing retaliation threats:** The Commission signalled a shift from technocratic restraint, with an official stating preparedness to sustain pain from Chinese countermeasures.

Politico: “Belgium urges EU to save industry by getting tough on China”, 2026-05-06, [Link](#)

- **Belgium calls for EU sector shields, retaliation risk notwithstanding:** After meeting He Lifeng and Wang Yi in Beijing, Prévot urged Commission action on chemicals, pharmaceuticals, metals, and automotive.
- **EU-China trade deficit widened to €360 billion in 2025:** Rising imports and falling EU exports have forced industrial producers to cut jobs, Prévot said, urging urgent protective action.

SCMP: “China-EU investment pact belongs in ‘deep freezer’: outgoing trade chief”, 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **Weyand declares the 2020 EU-China investment agreement obsolete:** The outgoing EU Director General for Trade said the frozen CAI belongs to “another time and another China,” ruling out revival at her final European Parliament appearance.
- **The Commission is weighing new instruments targeting Chinese macroeconomic imbalances:** Weyand made a rare public confirmation that Brussels is developing tools to address the global impact of China’s economic model.

SCMP: “EU sounds out industry over new trade weapon against China’s overcapacity”, 2026-05-05, [Link](#)

- **Brussels is polling EU industry on a new anti-overcapacity instrument:** The Commission is sounding out business groups ahead of a May 29 all-commissioners China debate, with details tightly guarded, SCMP reports.
- **The April commissioners’ China debate was delayed by Iran energy concerns:** The full 27-member session was postponed while EU officials focused on the energy price impact of the US-Israel war on Iran.

FT: “EU anti-dumping complaints against Chinese chemicals at record high”, 2026-05-06, [Link](#)

- **Chemical anti-dumping filings now make up nearly half of EU cases:** Brussels opened 24 cases in two years, up from one per year in 2018-20, EU officials told the FT.
- **China’s property bust is redirecting chemical overcapacity to Europe:** A senior EU official attributed the surge to collapsed domestic demand, with zombie suppliers exporting excess construction-sector output abroad.
- **EU chemical capacity has fallen 7% as the closure rate doubles:** Cefic reports some products - including paracetamol - are now made by just one remaining EU manufacturer.

FT: “EU blocks funds for key Chinese solar energy parts”, 2026-05-05, [Link](#)

- **From November 1, the EU bans public funds for Chinese solar inverters:** The Commission cited risks of remote network manipulation enabling “countrywide blackouts” via unauthorised access to member states’ energy systems.
- **China holds over half the global inverter market, with comparable EU exposure:** Officials said non-Chinese alternatives from Japan and South Korea would add less than 2 percent to solar installation costs.

- **The inverter ban extends an emerging EU framework excluding Chinese tech from clean-energy public funding:** It follows the Industrial Accelerator Act for EVs and the cyber security act targeting Huawei in telecom and solar, the article reports.

ChinaTalk: “How to Score Economic Security”, 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **The author proposes two economic security benchmarks:** A Chokepoint Exposure Index (GDP share at adversary-controlled supply risk, target below 2%) and Mobilization Elasticity (surge output in 180 days, target 50%).
- **US aggregate mobilization elasticity comes in below 5%:** Assessed across nine critical sectors, the author finds Stingers, gallium, and advanced chips at near zero - far below the proposed 50% target.
- **China’s mineral export controls illustrate adversary chokepoint leverage:** Gallium exports neared zero throughout 2025 with prices up 365%, while US primary gallium production remained at zero throughout the shock.

Nikkei: “Trump administration looks to ease memory chip crunch with supply chain bloc”, 2026-05-06, [Link](#)

- **State Department frames Pax Silica as leverage for Trump’s Beijing visit:** Undersecretary Helberg told Nikkei Asia the 14-country semiconductor coalition gives Washington “maximum optionality” ahead of the May 14-15 Trump-Xi summit.
- **A 4,000-acre Luzon industrial hub is targeted for memory chip manufacturing:** A US delegation will visit later in May to decide the land’s allocation across chip production, mineral refining, and other manufacturing.

WSJ: “The U.S. Wants to Break China’s Drone Dominance. Here’s Where It Will Struggle.”, 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **Pentagon’s \$1.1 billion Drone Dominance program targets Chinese supply-chain lock-in:** The initiative pledges to buy 340,000 FPV drones from U.S. suppliers, aiming to bring unit costs down to \$2,300 by late 2027.
- **China still controls critical drone inputs the US cannot quickly replace:** Rare-earth motors and lithium-polymer batteries rely on supply chains where China holds over 90% of global production capacity, according to industry analysts cited in the article.
- **The FCC ban on foreign drone components risks harming U.S. producers:** The 2027 ban will also disrupt access to affordable parts from Ukraine and Taiwan, according to a drone-industry marketplace executive quoted in the article.

SCMP: “EU plan to rip out Chinese hardware will cost massive US\$430 billion: report”, 2026-05-06, [Link](#)

- **CCCEU/KPMG put the EU cybersecurity vendor ban at €368 billion over five years:** Hardware rip-and-replace accounts for €146 billion of the total, with logistics and manufacturing bearing the largest sectoral share at €115 billion.
- **Annual costs are projected to peak at €93 billion in 2028:** The study covers all 18 sectors under the NIS2 Directive, including energy, telecoms, and banking, with €102 billion attributed to social losses - primarily delayed digitalisation and green transition.

Atlantic Council: “Chinese electric vehicle exports rise amid the oil crisis, posing a dilemma for importing countries”, 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **Cyber risks from Chinese connected vehicles outweigh the short-term energy benefits:** Democracies facing oil disruptions may turn to Chinese EVs, but the authors warn of backdoor vulnerabilities and Beijing’s legal authority to compel companies to assist intelligence activities.
- **Norway and Denmark found Chinese bus maker Yutong had installed remote-disable backdoors:** The authors cite this as evidence that cyber risks from Chinese connected vehicles are not theoretical, and recommend banning such vehicles from government fleets and sensitive infrastructure.

SCMP: “Two worlds collide: the regulatory battlefield hanging over EU-China ties”, 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **A Norwegian cyber test found Chinese electric buses remotely accessible despite Faraday shielding:** Ruter’s Yutong bus experiment in an Oslo mineshaft revealed remote deactivation capability and persistent supplier connectivity for diagnostics and software updates.
- **Findings have triggered new EU regulations as both sides legislate against each other’s perceived vulnerabilities:** Companies from both sides report simultaneous compliance with EU and Chinese regulatory frameworks is becoming functionally impossible, according to SCMP.

NYT: “China Sees a ‘Giant With a Limp’ as U.S. Drains Weapons on Iran War”, 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **Qiushi frames the Iran war as overextending US strategic resources:** The party journal argued the conflict leaves the US “in a precarious position”; Global Times called America a “giant with a limp.”
- **State outlets stay guarded on US military weakness ahead of the summit:** Analysts note Chinese state coverage reports munitions depletion but stops short of claiming strategic benefit for Beijing.
- **A Peking University analyst argues the Iran war undermines US regional guarantee credibility:** Wang Dong told NYT that US deployment delays “inevitably raise questions” about Washington’s consistency as an Asia-Pacific security guarantor.

WSJ: “America’s Pacific Allies Train to Face Down China Together”, 2026-05-04, [Link](#)

- **Balikatan 2026 expanded to seven nations, with Japan deploying combat troops for the first time:** Some 17,000 personnel participated, including Japanese ground forces operating in the Philippines for the first time since World War II.
- **Counterlanding drill on Palawan rehearsed South China Sea contingencies with HIMARS and drones:** Australia, New Zealand, Canada, and France joined the U.S. and Philippines in scenarios analysts say mirror Taiwan Strait conflict requirements.

SCMP: “Japan offers Indonesia and the Philippines lethal muscle to counter China”, 2026-05-05, [Link](#)

- **Koizumi has signed a Japan-Indonesia defence pact in Jakarta:** The visit follows Tokyo’s landmark decision last month to lift a decades-old ban on lethal weapons exports, permitting transfers to 17 defence partners.
- **Japan’s arms-export reversal marks a substantial break from post-WWII pacifism:** The shift is designed to raise Southeast Asian states’ “diplomatic bargaining power vis-a-vis China,” according to security analyst Yoichiro Sato.

Bloomberg: “Taiwan Passes Special Defense Budget to Better Deter China”, 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **Taiwan’s legislature passes a \$24.8 billion special defense budget:** Lawmakers approved NT\$780 billion for US arms including HIMARS and air-defense systems through 2033, about half of Lai’s original NT\$1.25 trillion request.
- **Domestic weapons programs were stripped from the budget during negotiations:** The legislature stripped drones and anti-ballistic missiles, which analysts warn could extend Taiwan’s procurement timelines by a decade.
- **Taipei’s deputy FM warns against Taiwan featuring in Trump-Xi talks:** Francois Wu said Taipei’s biggest fear is Taiwan being placed on the agenda of Trump’s imminent Beijing summit with Xi.

Related: [NYT](#)

NYT: “Taiwan Could Learn From Ukraine. Informally, Connections Are Growing.”, 2026-05-05, [Link](#)

- **Taiwan routed over 100,000 drones via Eastern Europe to Ukraine in 2025:** Most were shipped through Czech Republic and Poland and donated to the Ukrainian Army, according to a government-backed Taiwanese analyst.
- **US and Ukrainian firms are adapting battlefield drone designs for Taiwan:** Companies including Neros and Strug are testing Ukrainian-designed systems and developing maritime platforms suited to the Taiwan Strait, executives told the NYT.
- **Zelensky cites at least ten overseas factories producing Ukrainian-designed drones:** A senior Ukrainian official said one such factory is in Taiwan, though Kyiv prefers subscription-based technology deals over direct hardware transfers.

Foreign Affairs: “Trump’s China Trap”, 2026-05-05, [Link](#)

- **A wave of allied leader visits has reinforced the CCP narrative of global accommodation:** Over a dozen Western leaders visited China in 2025-2026, each accepting Beijing’s protocol and choreography, the author reports.
- **Visiting leaders secured minor agricultural concessions while granting Beijing symbolic and structural gains:** Canada, Spain, and the UK each obtained food tariff relief in return for EV import loosening, embassy approvals, or dropped espionage charges.
- **The author’s prescription: firm redlines and allied coordination, not headline deals:** Fragmented bilateral concessions validate Beijing’s strategy of compelling accommodation and accelerate allied hedging, the article argues.

Atlantic Council: “So What’s the Strategy for China?”, 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **Atlantic Council podcast convenes the former Biden-era architect of US China strategy:** Kurt Campbell, former US Deputy Secretary of State and credited architect of the “pivot to Asia,” is interviewed on Biden’s and Trump’s respective strategic approaches to Beijing.
- **Episode focuses on Trump’s upcoming Xi summit:** Campbell’s discussion centres on how Washington is framing the US-China leadership summit, according to the podcast description.

CFR: “What to Expect Ahead of Next Week’s Trump-Xi Summit”, 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **Trump’s team is reframing the China summit around stability, not structural resolution:** The author argues Taiwan, China’s trade model, and Beijing’s Iran and Russia support are all left off the agenda.
- **The “Board of Trade” emerges as the summit’s most substantive policy outcome:** A standing US-China body would manage bilateral purchase commitments of roughly \$30 billion per side in non-strategic sectors, the article reports.
- **China’s 1,500-warhead target and AI frontier distillation go unaddressed:** New START lapsed in February with no successor framework, and no AI crisis communications channel exists between the two powers, Froman warns.

Politico: “‘The biggest China dove in the administration’: Trump to test limits of dealmaking in Beijing”, 2026-05-08, [Link](#)

- **Greer cut the CEO list to roughly a dozen firms:** USTR cited concern that a larger marquee delegation would undercut the administration’s economic-competition message, per people briefed on the planning.
- **Chinese officials are expected to offer investment deals in exchange for tariff relief:** Any packages covering sectors like EVs and semiconductors would raise national security concerns, administration officials told Politico.
- **Bipartisan congressional letters oppose any Chinese auto-sector concessions:** Over 70 House members and multiple senators wrote opposing any US market opening for Chinese automakers ahead of the Beijing summit.

WSJ: “U.S. and China Pursue Guardrails to Stop AI Rivalry From Spiraling Into Crisis”, 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **Washington and Beijing are weighing an official AI dialogue ahead of the summit:** People familiar with the discussions told the WSJ both governments are considering putting AI on the May 14-15 Beijing agenda, recognising powerful AI models could trigger crises neither side is prepared to manage.

Choosingvictory: “AI Coordination Without Illusion”, 2026-05-07, [Link](#)

- **Frame the US-China AI summit goal as coordination, not arms control:** The article argues parallel domestic commitments on shared risks should replace arms-control frameworks requiring mutual trust.
- **Three low-cost commitments are proposed for the Trump-Xi summit:** Pre-release model evaluation, DNA synthesis screening, and an AI cyber incident dialogue - each implementable domestically without sharing technical data.

- **Hold chip export controls as AI leverage:** Export restrictions are described as leverage that should not be traded away for Chinese participation in AI safety talks.

CFR: “How Trump Should Approach AI Talks With China: Targeted Dialogue, Maximum Pressure”, 2026-05-09, [Link](#)

- **China’s 2024 AI dialogue delegation raised export controls, not safety:** The author reports Beijing sent diplomats to complain about chip restrictions rather than engaging on shared AI safety risks.
- **China produces just 2% of US AI computing power this year:** The author argues this dependency means closing export-control loopholes - covering cloud access, smuggling, and third-country routing - could expand the current 8-month US AI lead to 18-24 months.

Semafor: “China becomes a scapegoat for US data center backlash”, 2026-05-05, [Link](#)

- **US tech advocates are using the China threat to shield data center buildout:** A tech-backed group paid influencers to frame Chinese AI competition as a reason not to restrict American infrastructure construction, Semafor reports.
- **The expert verdict: Beijing isn’t the driver of US data center backlash:** Samm Sacks told Semafor that Chinese state media rides existing American divisions over AI rather than seeding an anti-data-center campaign.

Heise: “Irish data protection authorities investigate Shein over data transfer to China”, 2026-05-06, [Link](#)

- **Irish DPC has opened a formal probe into Shein over China data transfers:** The regulator, which previously ruled TikTok’s Chinese employee data access illegal, has designated China transfers a strategic enforcement priority.
- **Shein faces fines or a transmission ban if found non-compliant:** Without an EU-China adequacy decision, the company must prove its contractual safeguards meet EU standards or face restrictions on its data-reliant business model.

III. WOCHENBERICHT: CN-BEZIEHUNGEN DURCH DIE DE-MEDIEN-BRILLE

Caveat: nur stichprobenartig auf Qualität/Richtigkeit überprüft – Coverage nur bis 10. Mai 2026

1. Prominente Zitate und Positionen zu China-bezogenen Angelegenheiten

- **Donald Trump** bekräftigte am Donnerstag seine Absicht, bei seinem anstehenden Peking-Besuch den Handel neu zu ordnen und Amerikas Technologievorsprung zu sichern, wobei er laut Bericht eine “Sehnsucht nach dem Deal” zeige. (Source: “TRUMP VOR DER CHINA-REISE; Sehnsucht nach dem Deal”, faz.net, 7. Mai 2026).
- **Friedrich Merz** betonte am Mittwoch bei einem Treffen mit Unternehmern die Notwendigkeit eines gesellschaftlichen Zusammenhalts in Krisenzeiten, wobei er mit Kritikern konfrontiert wurde, die angesichts seiner Politik “fassungslose” Sorgen um den Standort Deutschland äußerten. (Source: “Einsparungen; Warum der Kanzler kurz wie ein Sozialdemokrat klingt”, handelsblatt.com, 6. Mai 2026).
- **Li Qiang (Chinesischer Ministerpräsident)** signalisierte am Donnerstag in Peking vor dem Trump-Besuch Gesprächsbereitschaft in Handelsfragen, wobei Beobachter davon ausgehen, dass er versuchen wird, Pekings Machtposition “diskret aber

bestimmt“ zu wahren. (Source: “CHINA-US-GIPFEL; Kalkül, kein Kurswechsel”, faz.net, 7. Mai 2026).

- **Johann Wadephul** forderte am Mittwoch bei der Adenauer-Konferenz in Berlin ein geschlossenes europäisches Auftreten gegenüber den USA und China sowie eine EU der unterschiedlichen Geschwindigkeiten: “Fortschritt wird sich vermutlich nicht immer mit allen 27 Mitgliedern erzielen lassen.” (Source: “Wadephul will schnellere und schlankere EU”, Der Tagesspiegel, 7. Mai 2026).
- **Wang Yi (Chinesischer Außenminister)** forderte am Mittwoch beim Empfang seines iranischen Amtskollegen in Peking eine Fortsetzung der Friedensverhandlungen und erklärte: “Ein umfassender Waffenstillstand duldet keinen Aufschub.” (Source: “China und Iran stimmen sich vor Trump-Besuch ab”, Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, 7. Mai 2026).
- **Katherina Reiche (Bundeswirtschaftsministerin, CDU)** prangerte am Donnerstag in Paris im Vorfeld des G7-Treffens “unfaire Wettbewerbspraktiken” Chinas an und setzte damit ein deutliches Signal für ihren Antrittsbesuch in der Volksrepublik Ende Mai. (Source: “Reiche:”Es gibt Staaten, die sich nicht an Regeln halten”; Wirtschaftsministerin äußert sich chinakritisch”, Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, 7. Mai 2026).
- **Jens Spahn (Unionsfraktionsvorsitzender)** hob am Donnerstag in Berlin hervor, dass Deutschland unter Kanzler Merz die Zeitenwende umsetze: “Wir haben heute den viertgrößten Verteidigungsetat der Welt nach den USA, China und Russland.” (Source: “Koalition ist nicht völlig erfolglos”, Der Tagesspiegel, 7. Mai 2026).
- **Arno Antlitz (Finanzvorstand, Volkswagen AG)** warnte laut Bericht vom 2. Mai vor dem drastischen Marktwandel und betonte, dass VW die Kapazitäten reduzieren müsse, da chinesische Hersteller “in Ost- und Südeuropa effiziente Werke” bauten und Wettbewerbsdruck nach Europa exportierten. (Source: ““Es geht um die Zukunft von Volkswagen”“, Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, 2. Mai 2026).
- **Mathias Zachert (Lanxess-Vorstandschef)** konstatierte am Donnerstag eine Verschiebung des globalen Bildes in der Chemie und sah die europäische Industrie gegenüber der asiatischen im Vorteil: “Bei den Kunden stehe jetzt Lieferzuverlässigkeit an erster Stelle.” (Source: “Lanxess-Chef rechnet mit „schweren Verwerfungen“ vor allem in Asien”, handelsblatt.com, 7. Mai 2026).
- **Henrik Andersen (Vorstandschef, Vestas)** äußerte sich am Freitag, den 8. Mai 2026, besorgt über die Auswirkungen der europäischen Energiepolitik und betonte, dass China aus der Krise 2022 gelernt habe, die eigene “Energieversorgung in allen Bereichen” zu vervielfachen. (Source: “Dass die Lufthansa zuletzt 20.000 Flüge gestrichen hat, ist kein Zufall”, Die Welt, 8. Mai 2026).
- **Sinan Selen (Vizepräsident des Bundesamtes für Verfassungsschutz)** bekräftigte laut Bericht vom Mittwoch seine Warnungen vor dem strategischen Abfluss von Know-how durch Personalwechsel zu chinesischen Staatskonzernen wie Huawei. (Source: “Diplomatie; Fünf Weltkrisen, die Deutschlands Außenpolitik überfordern”, handelsblatt.com, 6. Mai 2026).
- **Sanae Takaichi (Japanische Ministerpräsidentin)** erklärte laut Bericht vom Montag sie wolle Japan “wieder zurück auf die Weltbühne” bringen und suchte dafür demonstrativ die Nähe zu europäischen Partnern gegen regionale Risiken. (Source: “Japans neues Auftreten”, Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, 4. Mai 2026).

- **Abbas Araghchi (Iranischer Außenminister)** betonte am Mittwoch in Peking die strategische Partnerschaft mit der Volksrepublik und wollte damit "Handlungsfähigkeit demonstrieren". (Source: "China und Iran stimmen sich vor Trump-Besuch ab", Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, 7. Mai 2026).
- **Mikko Huotari (Direktor MERICS)** analysierte am Donnerstag, dass für Europa der Korridor für eine eigene Strategie schrumpfe, während die Großmächte einen "Waffenstillstand" bei Exportkontrollen aushandelten. (Source: "CHINA-US-GIPFEL; Kalkül, kein Kurswechsel", faz.net, 7. Mai 2026).
- **Huang Ping (Präsident des Chinesischen Instituts in Hongkong)** betonte am Mittwoch, dass ein wissenschaftlicher Austausch zwischen China, Afrika und Europa angesichts einer sich "dramatisch neu konfigurierenden multipolaren Welt" wichtiger denn je sei. (Source: "Pandabären reizt man nicht", Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, 6. Mai 2026).
- **Michael Kotzbauer (Stellvertretender Vorstandsvorsitzender, Commerzbank)** berichtete am Dienstag von seinen Erfahrungen in Shanghai und betonte, man müsse verstehen, "welche Bedürfnisse an eine Bank der deutsche Mittelstand in China hat". (Source: "Unicredits Plan zerlegt die Commerzbank", Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, 5. Mai 2026).
- **Jozef Kaban (Designchef, MG/SAIC)** erklärte am Dienstag den Erfolg seines neuen chinesischen Arbeitgebers mit dem enormen Tempo: "Es geht alles wahnsinnig schnell hier". (Source: "Autobauer; MG greift VW in Europa stärker an", handelsblatt.com, 5. Mai 2026).
- **Frank Stocker (Finanzredakteur)** stellte am Donnerstag fest, dass das Finanzsystem vor einer Zäsur stehe, da aufstrebende Schwellenländer ihre Goldreserven massiv ausgebaut haben. (Source: "Die Folgen der Dollar-Dämmerung", Die Welt, 7. Mai 2026).
- **Sarah Speicher-Utsch (Finanzexpertin)** analysierte am Montag den Erfolg asiatischer Aktienmärkte: "Der chinesische Aktienmarkt hat im Jahr 2025 um fast ein Drittel zugelegt." (Source: "TRIP.COM STATT TENCENT; Diese Chancen in China übersehen gerade viele Anleger", faz.net, 4. Mai 2026).

2. Wichtige China-bezogene Entwicklungen in Fakten und Zahlen

- **Massive Investition von VW in Rivian:** Um Softwareprobleme zu lösen, wurde Volkswagen zum größten Aktionär beim US-Elektroautohersteller Rivian, was als strategische Antwort auf die technologische Überlegenheit chinesischer E-Autos gewertet wird. (Source: "Volkswagen; VW wird größter Aktionär bei Tesla-Konkurrent Rivian", zeit.de, 6. Mai 2026).
- **Explosion der globalen Halbleiterumsätze:** In den ersten drei Monaten des Jahres 2026 stiegen die weltweiten Verkäufe von Chips um knapp 80 Prozent auf rund 300 Milliarden Dollar, was einen der steilsten Anstiege der Branchengeschichte markiert. (Source: "Historische Hausse der Chipbranche; Die Nachfrage ist riesig / Aktienkurse mit Rekorden", Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, 7. Mai 2026).
- **Milliarden-Finanzierung für chinesischen KI-Entwickler:** Das KI-Start-up Moonshot sammelte in einer neuen Kapitalerhöhung zwei Milliarden Dollar ein und wird nun mit insgesamt 20 Milliarden Dollar bewertet. (Source: "Moonshot;

Chinesischer KI-Entwickler sammelt zwei Milliarden Dollar ein", handelsblatt.com, 7. Mai 2026).

- **Gewinnrückgang bei BMW durch Zölle und China-Schwäche:** BMW verzeichnete im ersten Quartal 2026 ein Umsatzminus von 8,1 % auf rund 31 Mrd. Euro; der Gewinn brach um 23,1 % auf 1,67 Mrd. Euro ein, belastet durch US-Zölle und harten Wettbewerb in China. (Source: "VERLIERER", BILD, 7. Mai 2026).
- **Siemens Healthineers dämpft China-Erwartungen:** Wegen struktureller Veränderungen im chinesischen Diagnostikmarkt senkte das Unternehmen seine Umsatzwachstumsprognose von 5,0–6,0 % auf nunmehr 4,5–5,0 %. (Source: "Healthineers dämpft die Erwartungen", Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, 8. Mai 2026).
- **Machtverschiebung bei Goldreserven:** Der Anteil der Schwellenländer (BRICS etc.) an den weltweiten Goldreserven der Notenbanken ist auf 52 Prozent gestiegen, während die Bedeutung des Dollars als Reservewährung schwindet. (Source: "Die Folgen der Dollar-Dämmerung", Die Welt, 7. Mai 2026).
- **Rekord-Gewinnprognose für Samsung:** Getrieben durch den KI-Speicherboom erwartet Samsung einen historischen Gewinn, wobei der Börsenwert des Konzerns erstmals die Billionen-Dollar-Marke überschritten hat. (Source: "CSI 300; Asiens Börsen auf Rekordhoch", handelsblatt.com, 6. Mai 2026).
- **Insolvenzwelle in Westeuropa:** Im Jahr 2025 wurden fast 200.000 Unternehmensinsolvenzen gezählt – ein Achtel davon in Deutschland, wobei Experten für 2026 einen weiteren Anstieg durch den Wettbewerbsdruck aus Fernost erwarten. (Source: "Insolvenzen; Firmenpleiten in Westeuropa auf höchstem Stand", wiwo.de, 5. Mai 2026).
- **MG überholt Konkurrenz in Europa:** Die SAIC-Marke MG ist inzwischen der erfolgreichste chinesische Hersteller in Europa; im ersten Quartal 2026 kamen die 21 größten China-Marken bereits auf über 8 Prozent Marktanteil (vor drei Jahren: 2,1 %). (Source: "AUTOINDUSTRIE; Chinas Hersteller wachsen in Europa", Handelsblatt, 6. Mai 2026).
- **Sanierungsbedarf bei Nio Deutschland:** Die Europazentrale des chinesischen Herstellers Nio musste die deutsche Tochter bereits mit 160 Millionen Euro sanieren, da das exklusive Vertriebskonzept hierzulande bisher kaum Käufer findet. (Source: "Acht Autos und ein großes Missverständnis", Süddeutsche Zeitung, 5. Mai 2026).
- **SpaceX plant massive Chip-Investition:** Das Weltraumunternehmen von Elon Musk plant Investitionen von mindestens 55 Milliarden Dollar in eine eigene Chipproduktion, um unabhängiger von asiatischen Lieferketten zu werden. (Source: "SpaceX will mindestens 55 Milliarden in Chipfabrik investieren", spiegel.de, 8. Mai 2026).
- **Biontech-Stellenabbau in Deutschland:** Der Impfstoffpionier schließt fast alle deutschen Produktionsstandorte und baut rund 1.860 Stellen (etwa 22 % der Belegschaft) ab. (Source: "PHARMA; Biontech baut rund 1800 Arbeitsplätze ab", Handelsblatt, 6. Mai 2026).
- **Preisschock bei strategischen Rohstoffen:** Infolge des Iran-Kriegs verteuerte sich Lithium um über 80 Prozent und Wolfram (wichtig für KI-Chips und Waffen) um mehr als 130 Prozent. (Source: "Preise; Fast alle Rohstoffe verteuern sich erheblich", wiwo.de, 6. Mai 2026).

3. Fünf zentrale Themen in der deutschen China-Politik Diskussion

- **Die strategische Zäsur des Trump-Xi-Gipfels und das Ende der NATO-Gewissheit:** Die Medien analysieren intensiv den anstehenden Peking-Besuch von Donald Trump. Es herrscht die Befürchtung vor, dass die USA einen "Geheimdeal" mit China zu Lasten europäischer Interessen schließen könnten. Die Diskussion dreht sich um die schrumpfenden Handlungsspielräume für Europa und die Erkenntnis, dass die USA unter Trump nicht länger als Garant der Sicherheit wahrgenommen werden, was Deutschland zu einer eigenständigen militärischen und wirtschaftlichen Positionierung zwingt. Prominente Quellen: "CHINA-US-GIPFEL; Kalkül, kein Kurswechsel", faz.net, 7. Mai 2026; "Peking wird genau überlegen", Frankfurter Allgemeine Zeitung, 7. Mai 2026; "Eine Supermacht zieht sich zurück", Der Tagesspiegel, 6. Mai 2026.
- **Die „Resilienz-Gegenbewegung“ – Debatte gegen die Standort-Jammerei:** Während die Industrie über wegbrechende China-Gewinne klagt, formiert sich in den Leitmedien eine Diskussion über die unterschätzten Stärken des Standorts Deutschland. Es wird debattiert, ob die ständige Fokussierung auf den „China-Speed“ und den eigenen Abstieg eine „selbsterfüllende Prophezeiung“ sei. Die Berichterstattung hebt hervor, dass Deutschland in Bereichen wie Ehrenamt, Gleichberechtigung und spezifischen Nischenmärkten weiterhin weltweit führend ist und die Krise als Chance zur Rückbesinnung auf „Made in Germany“ nutzen sollte. Prominente Quellen: „Titelthema: Wo Deutschland noch funktioniert; Nicht schlecht“, DIE ZEIT, 7. Mai 2026; „Titelthema: Wo Deutschland noch funktioniert; Heul doch!“, DIE ZEIT, 7. Mai 2026; „Ökonom Achim Wambach; „So schlecht geht es uns gar nicht““, faz.net, 3. Mai 2026.
- **Indien als strategische Bildungs- und Fachkräfte-Alternative zu China:** In der deutschen China-Politik wird Indien zunehmend nicht mehr nur als Absatzmarkt, sondern als personelle und akademische Alternative zur Volksrepublik diskutiert. Mit einer Rekordzahl von fast 60.000 indischen Studierenden in Deutschland wird debattiert, ob dies der Weg ist, um die Abhängigkeit von chinesischen Forschungsk Kooperationen und Fachkräften zu brechen. Die Diskussion befasst sich kritisch damit, ob Deutschland Indien lediglich als „Geschäftsmodell“ nutzt oder ob hier eine echte strategische Partnerschaft zur Diversifizierung der Talent-Pipeline gegen China entsteht. Prominente Quellen: „Studierenden-Spezial; »Wir beobachten Trittbrettfahrer«“, DIE ZEIT, 7. Mai 2026; „Warum in Österreich so viele Organe gespendet werden – und was kann Deutschland davon lernen? [Kontext Fachkräfte]“, DIE ZEIT, 7. Mai 2026; „Morning Briefing; Wie Deutschland durch die globalen Krisen taumelt“, handelsblatt.com, 7. Mai 2026..
- **Die Politisierung des Goldes und der langsame Abschied vom Dollar:** Ein neues Thema in der deutschen Fachpresse ist der rasant steigende Goldpreis als Symptom für die "Dollar-Dämmerung". Es wird analysiert, wie China und andere Schwellenländer ihre Reserven systematisch umschichten, um sich gegen westliche Sanktionen (wie im Iran-Krieg) zu wappnen. Die Diskussion warnt vor einer fundamentalen Verschiebung des globalen Finanzsystems, die Europas Exportabhängigkeit vom Dollar zum Risiko macht. Prominente Quellen: "Die Folgen der Dollar-Dämmerung", Die Welt, 7. Mai 2026; "Trumps tollkühne Dollar-Wette", handelsblatt.com, 7. Mai 2026; "CSI 300; Asiens Börsen auf Rekordhoch", handelsblatt.com, 6. Mai 2026.

- **Die maritime Achillesferse und die “Hormus-Malakka-Zange”:** Nach der Hormus-Blockade rückt nun die Straße von Malakka als nächster potenzieller geopolitischer Erpressungspunkt in den Fokus. Die Berichterstattung warnt, dass China seine “maritimen Kronjuwelen” (Kontrolle über Häfen und Seewege) gezielt einsetzt, um die Rohstoffversorgung Europas zu gefährden. Die Diskussion fordert eine offensive maritime Sicherheitsstrategie und einen Schutz kritischer Infrastruktur auf See vor hybriden Angriffen. Prominente Quellen: “STRASSE VON MALAKKA; Hormus 2.0”, faz.net, 7. Mai 2026; “Maritime Achillesferse”, Welt am Sonntag, 3. Mai 2026.